Intemso — Business Overview

> ***The gig marketplace built for Ghanaian university students.***

What Is Intemso?

Intemso is an online marketplace that connects **university students in Ghana** with **people and businesses who need tasks done**. Think of it as the Upwork for campus — but designed from scratch for the Ghanaian student experience.

Students can earn flexible income around their lecture schedule by picking up short-term gigs — anything from delivering food on campus to designing a logo for a local business. Employers get access to a pool of verified, hungry, talented young people who are ready to work.

Our mission: Empower university students to earn while they learn, and give businesses a reliable, on-demand talent pool they can trust.

The Problem We're Solving

For students:

- Most students need extra income but can't commit to a 9-to-5 job
- Traditional freelancing platforms (Upwork, Fiverr) have high barriers — you need a portfolio, reviews, years of experience just to get started
- There's no organized way for students to find short-term, flexible work that fits around lectures and exams

For employers:

- Small businesses, entrepreneurs, and campus organizations regularly need help with tasks but don't want to hire full-time staff
- Finding reliable help is disorganized — WhatsApp groups, word-of-mouth, prayers
- No way to verify who you're hiring or guarantee the work will get done

Intemso fixes both sides. Students sign up in 2 minutes with just their university email — no CV, no portfolio, no experience required. Employers post what they need, students apply, and the platform handles everything: matching, communication, payments, and protection for both sides.

Who Is It For?

Students (The Talent)

Any university student enrolled at one of Ghana's 100+ recognized universities — KNUST, University of Ghana, Ashesi, UCC, GIMPA, you name it. Whether you're a first-year with no experience or a final-year Computer Science student who can build apps, there's work for you.

Employers (The Clients)

Anyone who needs something done:

- Local business owners ("I need someone to manage my Instagram for a month")
- Startups ("Build me a mobile app")
- Campus organizations ("Help set up our event this Saturday")

- Faculty members ("Transcribe these 20 lecture recordings")
- Individuals ("Deliver food to my office every Tuesday")

What Kind of Work?

We've organized over **320 different types of gigs** into **23 categories**. The beauty is that roughly 60% of these gigs require **zero special skills** — just willingness to show up and do the work.

Here's a taste:

Category	Examples
🏃 **Errands & Delivery**	Campus food delivery, grocery shopping, parcel delivery, pharmacy pickups
🎪 **Event Support**	Ushering, venue setup, decoration, registration desk, crowd management
📚 **Tutoring**	Math tutoring, WASSCE prep, essay editing, thesis formatting, IELTS prep
📲 **Social Media**	Instagram management, TikTok content, Canva graphics, hashtag research
📸 **Photography & Video**	Event photography, product shoots, promotional videos, graduation filming
⌨️ **Typing & Data Entry**	Transcription, PDF to Word, spreadsheet entry, document formatting
🧹 **Cleaning & Organizing**	Room cleaning, car detailing, closet organizing, post-event cleanup
💻 **Web & App Development**	Websites, mobile apps, dashboards, admin panels
🎨 **Creative & Design**	Poster design, brand identity, logo creation, gift wrapping
🍳 **Food & Cooking**	Meal prep, cooking for gatherings, baking, catering assistance
🚚 **Transport**	Designated driver, airport pickup, shopping companion
🎓 **Campus-Specific**	Lecture note sharing, dorm setup, campus orientation, club event help

...and 11 more categories covering sales, office admin, physical/manual work, tech support, writing, surveys, and more.

The key insight: **not every gig is a tech job.** A student who's great at organizing can clean offices. A student who's social can usher events. A student who can cook can prep meals. Everyone has something to offer.

How It Works

For Students

1. Sign up (2 minutes) Create an account with your university email and verify it. Add your name, university, skills, and what kind of work you're interested in. That's it — you're in.

2. Browse and apply Search gigs by category, budget, location, or urgency. When you find one you like, submit a proposal — your pitch to the employer explaining why you're the right person. Include your proposed rate and timeline.

3. Get hired and work The employer reviews proposals and picks who they want. You'll chat directly through the app to discuss details. For bigger projects, the work is broken into checkpoints (milestones) so everyone stays on the same page.

4. Get paid securely When you complete work and the employer approves it, the money goes straight to your bank account or mobile money. The platform holds the money in escrow the entire time — so you're guaranteed to get paid for work you complete, and the employer only pays for work they approve.

For Employers

1. Post your gig (free) Describe what you need, set your budget and timeline. You can either set a fixed price for the whole job or pay by the hour.

2. Review applications Students apply with proposals. You can see their profiles, ratings from past work, skills, and university. Chat with them before deciding.

3. Track the work For bigger projects, you fund milestones upfront (the money is held safely by the platform, not released yet). The student works, submits deliverables, and you review.

4. Approve and pay Happy with the work? Approve it and the payment is released to the student. Not happy? Request a revision (up to 2 rounds per milestone). Leave a rating and review so the next employer knows what to expect.

How We Make Money

Students pay a small service fee on earnings (sliding scale):

Earnings with a client	Platform fee
First GH₵500	20%
GH₵501 – GH₵2,000	10%
Above GH₵2,000	5%

The fee **decreases** the more a student earns with the same client. This rewards long-term relationships — the more you work with someone, the more you keep.

Real example: A student earns GH₵3,000 total with one client:

- GH₵500 × 20% = GH₵100
- GH₵1,500 × 10% = GH₵150
- GH₵1,000 × 5% = GH₵50
- **Total fee: GH₵300 out of GH₵3,000 (10% overall)**

Students also use "Connects" to apply for gigs:

- Every student gets **10 free connects per month**
- Each proposal costs 2–6 connects depending on the gig
- Need more? Buy packs:
  - 10 connects = GH₵5
  - 20 connects = GH₵9
  - 40 connects = GH₵16

Why connects? They stop students from spamming every gig with low-effort applications. If you have to "spend" something to apply, you only apply to gigs you actually want and can do. This makes the experience better for everyone — employers get serious applicants, students face less competition from spam.

Employers pay nothing to the platform.

Posting gigs, browsing talent, hiring — all free. They only pay the agreed budget to the student.

What Makes It Safe & Trustworthy

1. Verified Students Only

Every student must verify through their university email. No random accounts — you know you're dealing with a real university student.

2. Escrow-Protected Payments

When an employer funds a milestone, the money is held securely by our payment partner (Paystack — one of Africa's most trusted payment processors). The student sees the money is there and works with confidence. The employer knows the money won't be released until they approve the work. If the employer doesn't respond within 14 days, the money auto-releases to the student.

3. Ratings & Reviews (Both Ways)

After every completed gig, both sides leave ratings and reviews (1–5 stars plus written feedback). These are public on their profiles. Good work builds reputation. Bad behavior is visible to everyone.

4. Job Success Score

Every student gets a score (0–100%) calculated from their track record — client ratings, completion rate, responsiveness, and disputes. This score is visible to employers and helps them hire with confidence.

5. Talent Badges

Students earn visible badges as they build their reputation:

- **Rising Talent** — Completed at least 1 gig with a perfect score
- **Top Rated** — 90%+ success score, 10+ completed gigs, strong earnings history
- **Top Rated Plus** — By invitation only. The best of the best.

6. Dispute Resolution

If something goes wrong, either side can open a dispute. Our team mediates and resolves it fairly within 48 hours. No one gets scammed.

7. Content Moderation

All gig listings, messages, and community posts are monitored. Users can report inappropriate content, and our admin team takes action — removing posts, warning users, or suspending accounts when necessary.

Payment Methods

Employers can pay using:

- Mobile money (MTN, Vodafone, AirtelTigo)
- Credit/debit cards
- Bank transfer

Students can withdraw to:

- Mobile money (instant)
- Ghanaian bank account
- No minimum withdrawal amount — take out even small earnings

All payments are processed through **Paystack**, which is licensed, regulated, and trusted across Africa.

Beyond Just Gigs — The Full Platform

🎨 Talent Showcase

Students can create a visual portfolio to show off their best work — like a Dribbble or Behance but for Intemso. Upload project screenshots, describe what you did, list the skills you used. Employers browse the showcase to discover talented students before even posting a gig. It's a "show, don't tell" feature that lets skilled students stand out.

👥 Community Feed

A social feed (think LinkedIn meets campus WhatsApp group) where students and employers can:

- Share tips, achievements, and advice
- Discuss gigs and industry topics
- Post events and opportunities
- Follow other users for a personalized feed
- @mention people in conversations
- Search posts and discover trending topics

When a student completes a gig, an achievement post is automatically generated — " 🏆 Kwame just completed 'Admin Dashboard' for TechStart Ghana!" — giving them visibility and social proof.

🔍 Talent Search

Employers don't have to wait for applications. They can proactively search for talent by:

- Skills (e.g., "Flutter developer" or "event usher")
- University (e.g., only KNUST students)
- Rating and success score
- Hourly rate range
- Availability

Find someone perfect? Invite them directly to your gig or send a message.

💬 Real-Time Messaging

Built-in chat between students and employers. Share files, discuss requirements, coordinate work — all inside the platform. No need to exchange personal phone numbers or move to WhatsApp.

📊 Dashboard

Every user gets a personal dashboard showing:

- Active contracts and their progress
- Proposals sent and their status
- Earnings and payment history
- Messages and notifications
- Profile completeness score

- Quick stats (jobs completed, success rate, average rating)

The Market Opportunity

Ghana has 100+ accredited universities with hundreds of thousands of students.

- **University of Ghana** (Legon)
- **KNUST** (Kumasi)
- **University of Cape Coast**
- **Ashesi University**
- **GIMPA**
- **University of Education, Winneba**
- **Central University**
- **Ghana Institute of Journalism**
- **UPSA**
- **Wisconsin International University**
- *...and 90+ more including all public, technical, chartered private, and professional institutions*

The reality: Most of these students need money. Many have skills. There's no organized platform connecting them with the businesses and individuals who need help. The workarounds — WhatsApp groups, notice boards, word-of-mouth — are unreliable, unsafe, and unscalable.

Intemso fills that gap with a structured, trustworthy, and scalable solution.

Why This Works (Our Advantages)

1. Zero Barrier to Entry

Unlike Upwork or Fiverr where you need a portfolio, reviews, and years of experience to even get your first gig — Intemso lets any university student start immediately. University email verification is the only requirement.

2. Both Simple and Skilled Work

Other platforms focus on skilled freelancing (design, coding, writing). Intemso includes simple tasks too — errands, event help, cleaning, delivery. This means 100% of students can participate, not just the technically skilled ones.

3. Campus-Centric Design

The entire platform is built around the student lifestyle:

- Flexible scheduling around lectures and exams
- Campus-local gigs (no commuting to Accra for a Kumasi student)
- Academic calendar awareness
- Student-friendly pricing

4. Trust Built In

In a market where "I paid someone on WhatsApp and they disappeared" is common, Intemso's escrow system, verified profiles, and review system solve the trust problem for both sides.

5. Network Effects

The more students join → the more employers post gigs → the more students earn → the more students join. Once this flywheel starts on a campus, it becomes the default way students find work and businesses find help.

6. Ghana-First

Built specifically for Ghana — mobile money payments, local universities, GH₵ pricing, Ghanaian business context. Not a Silicon Valley product awkwardly adapted for Africa.

What Students See When They Join

1. **Homepage** — A bold landing page showcasing the platform, categories, and how it works
2. **Find Work** — Browse all available gigs with search and filters
3. **Showcase** — Visual gallery of student portfolio projects
4. **Community** — Social feed with tips, achievements, discussions, and events
5. **Dashboard** — Personal hub for contracts, proposals, earnings, messages, and profile management

What Employers See When They Join

1. **Homepage** — Same landing page, but CTAs to "Hire Students"
2. **Find Talent** — Browse and search student profiles
3. **Post a Gig** — Create a new gig listing in minutes
4. **Showcase** — Discover skilled students through their portfolio work
5. **Dashboard** — Manage gigs, review proposals, track contracts, message students

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The Vision

Phase 1 (Now): Launch on a few campuses in Ghana. Prove the model. Get students earning, get employers hiring, build the flywheel.

Phase 2: Expand to every university in Ghana. Become the default platform for student gig work nationwide.

Phase 3: Expand across West Africa — Nigeria, Kenya, South Africa. The student talent pool is massive across the continent, and the same problems exist everywhere.

The end goal: When any university student in Africa needs to earn money, or any business needs quick, reliable help — everyone's first thought is Intemso.

Quick Numbers

Metric	Value
Gig categories	23
Individual gig types	320+
Supported universities	100+ (Ghana)
Student signup time	Under 2 minutes
Employer cost to post	Free
Payment protection	100% escrow
Student service fee	5–20% (sliding scale)
Payment methods	Mobile money, bank, cards

Minimum withdrawal	No minimum

Built in Ghana. For Ghana. By students who understand the hustle.